

UNIT 5 READY FOR ACTION

PUPIL'S BOOK pp. 61-72	FUNCTIONS	GRAMMAR	VOCABULARY	CROSS-CURRICULAR ELEMENT	SUGGESTED LESSON SCHEDULE
Lesson 1 An ambitious Class Project	Learning to express Intentions, Plans, Arrangements and Predictions.	Using the Present Progressive to express Intentions, Plans and Arrangements. Using Future Simple to express predictions.	Language, Literature, Drama, Arts & Crafts, Storytelling & Storywriting.	All related to the Environment: to recycle, to reduce, to save, to survive, to protect, to (re)use, to collect, to take action for/ against, to litter	4 teaching periods 1) A. Lead – In; B. Listening; C. Role Play. 2) D. Writing; Grammar. 3) E. Listening; F. Quiz. 4) Portfolio.
Lesson 2 Let's do it!	Learning how to express abilities, obligations and giving advice.	Using Can to express abilities. Obligations with Must. Expressing advice with Should.	Using Can to express abilities. Obligations with Must. Expressing advice with Should.		4 teaching periods 1) A. Lead-In; B. Reading; C. Speaking & Writing. 2) D. Listening; E. Speaking. 3) Grammar; F. Pair/Group Work. 4) G. Reading & Writing.
Lesson 3 My Work Can Make a Difference	Expressing/ Giving advice.		Recyclable, environmental, environmentally friendly, rechargeable, illegal		3 teaching periods 1) A. Lead-In; B. Speaking & Writing. 2) Project. 3) Self-Assessment Test

UNIT 5

READY FOR ACTION

Cover page p. 61

Time: 3-5 mins

Invite pupils to look at the cover page and initiate discussion about recycling. Ask them to describe what they see in the images.

- Questions: "What do the first four pictures have in common? They refer to the environment, litter and recycling.", "What does the sign on the bins mean? Only recyclable litter", "What do you know about recycling? It is essential to save our planet", "Do you or your families recycle? Yes/No", "What is the connection between litter and the last two pictures? Litter damages our planet."
- You could also pre-teach vocabulary; e.g. recycling / to recycle / recyclable / litter / garbage / rubbish / litter bin / glass / aluminium / paper/ plastic/ to reduce, etc.

TAPESCRIPT

Boy: One million of different species of animals and plants are in danger.

24 species of Australian butterflies are in danger.

Volunteer work can help the planet. Join 'Youth Camp' now!!! You and your family can work in Greece, Italy, Turkey and Esthonia.

Empty villages, dead people, dead animals, burnt trees are what the fire left behind in Italy, Spain, Turkey, Greece and other places in Europe.

LESSON 1

AN AMBITIOUS CLASS PROJECT

Aims of the Lesson

- a. To introduce the idea of producing less rubbish as a solution to the problems of the environment.
- b. To teach vocabulary related to litter and recycling.
- c. To express intentions, plans and arrangements together with expressions for predictions and hypotheses.

d. To teach Future Simple tense, 'be going to' and Present Progressive tense.

e. To encourage pupils to personalize issues and take action - make a list of intentions and plans and then try to follow them through.

A. LEAD-IN

PB page: 62 / Time: 3-5 mins

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

Initiate discussion about the recycling logo. Ask them where we can find this. Tell them the item is environmentally friendly and can be recycled where facilities are available. Explain that if they visit the Greenpeace website they will be able to find more information on recycling.

Greek website for WWF: www.wwf.gr
(Useful websites P.B. Appendix: p. 140)

WWF (World Wildlife Fund) Greece

WWF Greece, the conservation organization, was founded in 1990. It is actively supported by its 11,000 members. With its headquarters in Athens, it has established local teams in N. Pindos, Dadia, Lake Kerkini, Lake Prespa, Zakynthos island and Kastelorizo island. In addition, it expresses integrated positions on specific environmental issues and addresses these to the political authorities.

From "Exhibition on the nature and culture of Zagori" booklet

B. LISTENING

PB page: 62 / Time: 10 mins / TB Introduction p. 10

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

Pre-Listening

Tell pupils that they are going to listen to Kostas and Mark talking to each other.

While-Listening

Play the tape/CD once and ask the pupils what the main idea or gist of the listening passage is.

TAPESCRIPT

Mark: Hello, there, Kostas! How are you today?

Kostas: Oh, hi, Mark! I'm fine, very busy...

Mark: Busy? Why? Are you studying?

Kostas: Not exactly. You see, I'm working on an environmental project.

Mark: Oh, that sounds interesting! What exactly are you doing?

Kostas: Well, our teacher suggested that we should think of various ways to protect our environment. So, we're going to organise a project on recycling.

Mark: Wow, that's great, Kostas! Are you going to hold an exhibition at school?

Kostas: Well, actually we're going to try to persuade our friends and our teachers to recycle paper, aluminium, glass and plastic.

Mark: Oh, I haven't thought of recycling plastic... Is that possible?

Kostas: Yes, of course it is. Everything needs to be possible if we want to save our planet. So, tomorrow morning we're handing out leaflets and brochures giving information and encouraging everyone at school to take recycling seriously. If we succeed, we'll manage to do something about our future.

Mark: That's a terrific idea! I think I'll try it out myself with my classmates. I'll let you know as soon as I have news. But, please, do let me know about your results.

Kostas: Ok, I will. I must get back to work now. Talk to you soon.

Mark: Yes, talk to you tomorrow!

Post-Listening

- Ask pupils to read and discuss the statements in the second part of this activity.
- Play the tape/ CD again and let them check their answers.
- Explain unknown words or phrases. You could use realia in order to teach words like leaflets or brochures. For the rest of the vocabulary you could use L1 so that pupils transfer knowledge from their Environmental Education subject.

KEY

1 F, 2 T, 3 T, 4 F, 5 T

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 5 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY A • p. 30

KEY 1. organize, 2. environmental, 3.

hand, 4. persuade, 5. recycle, 6. hold, 7. save, 8. terrific, 9. let, 10. results
DIFFERENTIATED ACTIVITY A • p. 75

KEY

A4-A14: environment,
15I-15B: brochure, 1C-1L: exhibition,
14E-14K: project, E14-E8: protect,
7E-7K: recycle, F3-F8: leaflet,
3E-3K: results, K6-K13: persuade,
M11-M3: encourage, K9-H12: save,
C3-C10: organize

C. ROLE PLAY

PB page: 62 / Time: 10-15 mins / TB
Introduction p. 11

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

Pre-Role Playing

- In pairs. Here's the part of the dialogue they should use in their role-play – it must be either photocopied or written on the blackboard. Alternatively, the pupils could create their own dialogue.

Kostas: Well, our teacher suggested that we should think of various ways to protect our environment. So, we're going to organize a project on recycling.

Mark: Wow, that's great, Kostas! Are you going to hold an exhibition at school?

Kostas: Well, actually we're going to try to persuade our friends and our teachers to recycle paper, aluminium, glass and plastic.

Mark: Oh, I haven't thought of recycling plastic... Is that possible?

Kostas: Yes, of course it is. Everything is possible if we want to save our planet.

- This section can be changed with the prompts provided in the Pupil's Book.
- Pupils should take turns and act out the dialogue.
- To provide a model, role play the dialogue with one of the pupils in front of the class.

While-Role Playing

- Make sure they use L2 during the activity.
- Move among the pairs and help when you are asked to.
- Stop them when the time limit is up and ask 1 or 2 pairs to act it out in front of

their classmates.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 5 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY B • p. 30

KEY 1 d, 2 f, 3 i, 4 b, 5 g, 6 h, 7 c, 8 a, 9 e

D. WRITING

PB page: 63 / Time: 2-3 mins / TB Introduction p. 10

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

- On a piece of paper, pupils write a list of three of the things they discussed and put their names underneath. This is their commitment to help improve the environment.
- Put the pieces of paper on the classroom noticeboard and remind them at the end of the unit to put a tick or a cross next to the things they did to help reduce rubbish production.
- Identify pupils who have achieved the most for a special mention.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 5 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY C • p. 31

KEY 1. will travel, 2. are you doing/ is having/am taking, 3. will you do, 4. will be/ am going to ask or will ask, 5. are working/ are going to recycle/ are going to visit/ ask/ are going to plant/ will succeed.

DIFFERENTIATED ACTIVITY C • p. 76

KEY 1. will, 2. are you going to do, is having, I'm taking, 3. will you do?, I'll be, I'm going to ask, 4. are working, are going to recycle, are going to visit, are going to ask, are going to plant, will?

GRAMMAR FOCUS

PB page: 63 / Time: 10 mins / TB Introduction p. 12

Aims: To teach

- BE GOING TO for INTENTIONS
- PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE for PLANS & ARRANGEMENTS
- FUTURE SIMPLE TENSE for PREDICTIONS & HYPOTHESES

Presentation

- Invite pupils to look at the Grammar Section of this lesson. Ask them to study the examples and elicit the rules

and structures used for expressing the functions included in the box.

- Explain to them these are ways of expressing something that will most probably take place in the future. The different structures mean the different degrees of probability.
- You can present the following diagram on the blackboard
 - When something is likely to happen we use the Future Simple tense
 - When something is already arranged and will definitely happen we use the Present Progressive tense
 - When it is our intention to happen we use the be going to form
- Ask pupils to look for similar expressions in the dialogue (p. 62), while they are listening to it again and try and identify their function.
- Finally, ask the pupils to tell you how the three different structures are formed

Future Simple: **will + base form**

Present Progressive:

is/are/am + -ing

Is/are/am + going to

+ base form

- Always remind pupils that they can refer to the Grammar section at the back of the book so that they revise or check Grammar items. (Note: this will be added at a later stage).

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 5 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY D • p. 31

KEY Sample answers TB p. 126.

E. LISTENING

PB page: 63 / Time: 5-7 mins / TB Introduction p. 10

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

Pre-Listening

- Individually. Tell the pupils that now they are going to listen to another pupil talking to a local reporter. They are talking about a project about the environment.
- Ask them to read the instructions and check they know what they have to do.
- Teach unknown words and explain that

holding a paper recycling drive means organizing a paper recycling campaign.

While-Listening

Play the tape / CD as many times as needed for the pupils to be able to understand.

TAPESCRIPT

Reporter: *Well Jack, can you tell us a few things about the project?*

Jack: *Yes, sure! Well, it's all about our class trip, you know. We are going to collect money for this and we thought that we could organize a campaign. So, we're holding a paper recycling drive to pay for this trip. We are putting bins in the school in order to collect used paper. We're also bringing old newspapers and magazines from home. It's so nice to know that every ton of paper that we recycle, we can save 17 trees from being cut down to make new paper! We believe that in the end we'll manage to get the money we need.*

Reporter: *I hope everything turns up the way you want. Good luck !*

Adapted from

<http://www.epa.gov/recyclecity/>

KEY 1. A, 2. B, 3. B, 4. C.

Post-Listening

- In pairs, pupils check their answers.
- As a whole class activity, discuss for 2-3 minutes the feasibility of implementing such a project at their school.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 5 • LESSON 1 • ACTIVITY E • p. 32

KEY

PAPER BOX	METAL BOX	PLASTIC BOX
comics	spoon	doll
magazines	can	plastic bag
newspaper	cd	car model

COMPOST BOX	GLASS BOX
potato	jar
tomato	bottle
lettuce	window

F. QUIZ

PB page: 64 / Time: 5-10 mins / TB Introduction p. 11

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

- In pairs, pupils do the quiz. This will sensitize them and hopefully may make them understand how much damage we can cause to the world around us.
- Let them check their answers with other pairs.
- Discuss the issues – ask for ideas how to stop environmental destruction. Make them discuss about ways they could recycle at home. Elicit responses about recycling programmes in their areas. “Are there such programmes in our municipality?” “Do you participate?”, “What are the advantages of taking part?” “Are there any problems?” etc.

KEY

1. 2,800,000,000
2. 28,000,000,000
3. 4,900,000,000

G. PORTFOLIO

PB page: 64 / Time: 7-10 mins / TB Introduction p. 14

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

- In pairs, tell pupils to read the instructions and make a first draft of the letter.
- Allow peer correction.
- Peers return the drafts with comments and the pairs can re-write them and illustrate them in any way they prefer.
- Point out to the pupils the list of websites in Appendix p. 140. Suggest they could visit the ones which have interactive activities. All of them highlight how necessary recycling litter is.
- Another activity would be to visit the FUN PARK area in the CD ROM of the 6th Grade and do the recycling activities in the EXTRAS.

LESSON 2

LET'S DO IT

Aims of the Lesson

- To develop pupils' environmentally friendly behaviour
- To make them speak about what people can, must or should do

- about environmental problems
- c. To expose them to relevant issues and ideas and make them work with their peers to find solutions

A. LEAD-IN

PB page: 65 / Time: 3 mins

Initiate discussion and let pupils offer ideas about questions they would like to include in a questionnaire. Tell them that the use of questionnaires is common in surveys.

B. READING

PB page: 65 / Time: 20 mins / TB Introduction p. 9

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

Pre-Reading

- Ask pupils how much they know about electricity and how it is produced. You can talk about Ptolemaida, in Northern Greece, and the ΔEH power station that is the most important unit for the production and distribution of electricity in Greece.
- Also, talk about environmental problems in that area or any other place they know about.

While-Reading

- Now let them answer the questionnaire.
- In case they ask for words make them guess their meaning from the context. If they are unsuccessful, then offer explanation.
- In the end they should check and see how environmentally friendly each one is.

Post-Reading

- In pairs, let them compare results and ask pupils to report to the class.
- Discuss results and praise those who have done well. Offer suggestions to those who haven't – " From now on you could

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 5 • LESSON 2 • ACTIVITY A • p. 33

KEY

AT SCHOOL

- try to persuade classmates/ teachers
- avoid using plastic forks / knives / plates, etc.
- collect used paper / newspapers / magazines / recycling

- bring food from home / reusable boxes
- use notebooks/ made / recycled paper
- put recycling bins out of classrooms / teachers' room / playground

AT HOME

- try to persuade parents / family
- avoid using plastic forks / knives/ plates, etc.
- collect used paper/ newspapers / magazines / recycling
- plant a tree/ take care of it
- use re-chargeable batteries
- use notebooks/ made / recycled paper

C. SPEAKING & WRITING

PB page: 66 / Time: 10-15 mins / TB Introduction p. 10, 11

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

Stage 1

- Explain to pupils what they have to discuss here is only a plan. They don't have to do it now.
- First they choose a theme which is an environmental problem in their area.
- Then they must plan 3 activities, like the ones they have met in other parts of this unit and make notes under 3 different days of the week. Under each day they will describe one separate action they plan to undertake to help ease the problem.
- Offer ideas for problems and remind them of the project in the previous lesson. Ask them to use vocabulary they have already met.
- Set a time limit. It is important for children at this age to get accustomed to time restrictions so that they develop appropriate strategies in order to overcome the problem.

Stage 2

- In pairs, pupils work with their partner.
- Walk among the pairs and help with L2

Stage 3

- Ask pairs to exchange ideas and present their plan to their peers. They must also explain what the outcome of their campaign is expected to be.
- Ask them to report to the class and

encourage critical thinking by asking questions like: "What do you expect that will change?", or "Why do you think people will change their habits?", etc.

D. LISTENING

PB page: 67 / Time: 15 mins / TB Introduction p. 10

→ Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.

Pre-Listening

- Let pupils read the instructions and clarify unknown facts. E.g. explain to them that a summit meeting about the environment is a meeting where important people from different countries around the world discuss ways of protecting the environment. Countries are then asked to abide by and apply what is agreed in the summit meeting. Give examples of the Kyoto Protocol and talk about issues like Global Warming and climate change. Tell them that one of the factors which influence pollution is excessive littering.
- Make them guess what the listening will be about.
- re-teach unknown vocabulary items through pictures – cloth bag, plastic bag, packaging, groceries, cardboard box, to recycle, recyclable, to reuse, to protest, etc.

While-Listening

- Play the tape/ CD once.
- Pupils do the task.

TAPESCRIPT

Activist: ...but of course we can make a real difference! Even children like you can take action! For example, when you go shopping with your parents look for products that have less packaging or use ecological packaging. You can check the packaging by reading the symbols. Even better, you can also buy fresh, non-packaged produce. You can also ask your mum to bring a cloth bag or reuse an old plastic bag to carry home your groceries and other shopping. Why not ask for cardboard boxes at the supermarket? They can be reused for other purposes or recycled. And one more thing...when you shop, you

should always look for products that can be recycled – or have been recycled already. Look for the recycle symbol on the label.

Kostas: Do you really believe that we can make older people listen to us? But..... (fading out)

- Play the tape again if needed.

KEY Only b. is with a cross. All the other images are positive.

Post- Listening

In pairs pupils check their choices.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 5 • LESSON 2 • ACTIVITY B • p. 34

KEY

VIDEO	22,60 euros
DVD:	11,20 euros
CD PLAYER:	5,20 euros
PC SCREEN:	7,50 euros
PRINTER:	6 euros
SCANNER:	4,50 euros
MICROWAVE:	9 euros
WASHING	
MACHINE:	5,20 euros

GRAMMAR FOCUS

PB page: 68 / Time: 10 mins / TB Introduction p. 12

Presentation

- Ask pupils to look at the structures in this section.
- Remind them of modal verbs they had met in the book for D' class.
- Elicit rules – "How are they formed?"- modal + verb (infinitive), "Why are they called Modals?"- they are elliptical, they do not form all tenses, etc.
- Elicit forms for the functions presented here.
- Prompt pupils in order to elicit responses where pupils use the structures. Use ideas from the questionnaire on page 65. Make questions like, "What must people do at the beach?", Tell what I should do at school in order not to produce litter", etc.
- Write their responses on the blackboard and they can use them later on in their projects.

E. PAIR WORK OR GROUP WORK

PB page: 68 / Time: 10-15 mins / TB Introduction p. 11

- In pairs or groups of 4 pupils. Pupils read the instructions and then discuss what their posters will include.
- Draw their attention and comment on other posters which may already be on the classroom walls or in the school. Comment on what makes them successful.
- Offer ideas so that pupils who are competent in Art can make the drawings.
- Set a time limit and move among the groups. Offer your help when asked for it. Ensure that pupils use L2.

F. READING & WRITING

PB page: 69 / Time: 20 mins / TB Introduction pp. 9-10.

→ **Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.**

Pre-Reading

- Invite pupils to guess from the title and the illustration what the reading passage is going to be about.
- Use a map to ensure that pupils know which is the Mediterranean Sea and which countries are called Mediterranean. Remind them of vocabulary items related to countries and nationalities, geography and borders, weather, etc
- Elicit problems in the Mediterranean area, e.g. sea pollution, climate changes, fires, forest destruction, wars etc.

While-Reading

In pairs, pupils make a chart with 3 columns listing country, problem and where possible an idea for a solution.

Post-Reading

Pupils present findings and discuss.

LESSON 3

MY WORK CAN MAKE A DIFFERENCE!

Aims of the Lesson

- a. To encourage pupils to mediate and give advice to people who do not speak the Greek language.

- b. To engage them in organizing bigger projects that can be relevant to their situation following steps and applying what has already been discussed.
- c. To boost their confidence and encourage critical thinking.
- d. To make them utilize Internet sources to elicit relevant information.

A. LEAD-IN

PB page: 70 / Time: 5 mins

→ **Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.**

Let pupils brainstorm and use their experience to talk about the issues in this section.

Background information

- When you enjoy a walk in nature, please carry a bag for your litter. Garbage is a product of our modern civilization, but does not have a place in nature.
- Be informed by the local authorities regarding the existing legal framework for the protection of northern Pindos.
- If you are amateur fisherman, we inform you that in the Voidomatis river fishing is prohibited all year round.
- Avoid collecting flowers, since you risk cutting rare, protected or endemic flora species of the area.
- If you wish to rest by the river or the forest, avoid the use of soaps and other polluting substances that threaten the fragile flora and fauna of the area.

Adapted from WWF leaflet "Visitor Code of Conduct" distributed at the Zagori area of northern Pindos.

B. SPEAKING & WRITING

PB page: 70 / Time: 10 mins / TB Introduction pp. 10-11

→ **Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.**

Stage 1

- Inform pupils that they will need to use mediation tasks for this activity. Explain to them that mediation is not translation. They must read PB, Appendix, p. 141 (in Greek) and use the information to give some information and advice to people

who cannot speak or read Greek. They must “mediate” so that a problem can be solved.

- Then, elicit or offer information about the area of Zagorohoria and the protected area of the Pindos forests.

Background information

Zagori is situated on the northwestern edge of the Pindos mountain range and consists of 46 settlements, surrounded by steep mountains.

The following types of vegetation are found in Zagori: Sub-alpine and alpine meadows, beech forests, black pine forests, fir forests, oak forests, holly oak, and hornbeam, riverside vegetation.

The area is protected by UNESCO and is characterized as national heritage. The area of the mountain of Pindos around Papigo village is considered protected and for this reason no logging or hunting is permitted.

Every species of large mammal found in Greek mainland, except of the red deer, have their habitats in Zagori. The majority of these are rare and protected under national and international legislation- the brown bear, the Balkan chamois, the roe deer, the wolf, the otter and others.

Famous sights of the area: the Vikos gorge, the Voidomatis river and its springs which is considered the clearest river in Europe, the Aoos gorge, etc.

Adapted from the WWF booklet about the Zagori area – The Papigo Information Centre for Nature and Culture in Zagori, operated by WWF Greece in collaboration with the Community of Papigo.

Stage 2

- In pairs, pupils work and complete chart.
- Then they form bigger groups and compare what each pair have produced.
- They can be encouraged to use some peer correction, correct or reformulate.

Stage 3

Their works can be used at the Computer Science hour to be typed and be ready to be included in the school newspaper or their Portfolio.

ACTIVITY BOOK:

UNIT 5 • LESSON 3 • ACTIVITY A • p. 35

Pupils fill in personal details.

PROJECT

PB page: 70 / Time: 30 mins / TB Introduction p. 15

→ **Cross-curricular link: ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES.**

- In groups of 3-4 pupils, let pupils choose which project they would like to do.
- Then they must decide
 - a. about the issue
 - b. the final product, i.e. booklet, leaflet, picture, poster, letter, etc.
 - c. materials they would need
 - d. a visit to the area to take photos or video
 - e. other ideas
- Ask them to decide about who is going to do what
- Tell them to keep notes and then use them for the final product
- They should be advised to accept others' ideas and suggestions
- Finally, encourage them to work on the internet or with encyclopedias or other resources to get ideas and information.
- Facilitate their work but do not do it for them.
- Praise them and give them opportunities to demonstrate their work to other pupils or teachers and parents. Put them on the walls, the school newspaper, the school web page, etc.

BOARD GAME: See PB Appendix, pp. 142-143 for fun recycling game.

CULTURAL CORNER

a. Recycling at school Library

The school library is the best place to learn about reuse, because that's what a library is all about. Because these books can be borrowed, read, and returned, their reuse saves thousands of trees.

Rebuilt computers, purchased from the local Mr. Fix-it Shop with money raised from the students' recycling drives, also help preserve our natural resources. Many

students use the computers to do their schoolwork, saving paper by making all of their changes before printing out the final copy.

Also, because of computers, students can use the Internet to tap the local newspaper, Recycle City University, and research centers and databases around the world. Getting information through the computer saves paper, and reduces energy consumption and pollution by eliminating the need to drive from place to place to get what they need.

Background information

Forest fires in the Mediterranean:

A burning issue

The Mediterranean has been identified by WWF as one of the most important regions in the world for its outstanding biodiversity features. Mediterranean forests, situated in a transitional zone between the European, African and Asian continents, are one of the planet's centres of plant diversity, with 25,000 floral species representing 10% of the world's flowering plants on just over 1.6% of the Earth's surface. They also play host to an amazing faunal diversity.

But the Mediterranean forests are also under serious threat, with forest fires, in most cases deliberately set, playing a major role in their degradation and bringing about huge social, economic and environmental effects.

There is a strong need to put in place an effective policy of prevention to address the root causes of this phenomenon.

The issue

The Mediterranean region is heavily affected by forest fires; every year more than 50,000 fires burn an estimated

average of 600,000 - 800,000 hectares, an area comparable to the island of Crete or the island of Corsica, and equal to 1,3 - 1,7 % of the total Mediterranean forests.

While small-scale fires may be part of the natural dynamics and the management of the natural resources, large-scale forest fires throughout the region have dramatically increased during the last few decades, mainly as a consequence of the rapid land-use changes, socio-economic conflicts and competing interests characterising the Mediterranean region in the last decades.

EU Mediterranean countries - Spain, Portugal, Italy and Greece - have been particularly affected: the average total burnt area in these countries has quadrupled since the 60's.

Of all the forest fires in the Mediterranean, human induced ones, mostly due to deliberate lighting of forest fires and negligence, account for more than 95%.

As a result of the intensification of forest fires, the capacity of the Mediterranean ecosystems to naturally regenerate in many areas has been reduced, while extensive areas are being affected by biodiversity loss, soil erosion and water scarcity.

Indeed, forest fires aggravate soil erosion, leading ultimately to desertification. This also leads to huge economic costs.

The risk of forest fires is further aggravated by the current climate change trend in the Mediterranean region, which is also reducing the capability of Mediterranean forests to accommodate them.

Source:

www.panda.org/about_forest/forestfires2003factfiles